

Little did I know, I was running on an elongated caffeine rush toward learning about money management. As time progressed, my interest shrunk and wound up like sunflowers during the anti-season. And then I had a period when I'd just stay away from anything related to finance. Needless to say, I very soon learnt this is how people felt over several issues such as fitness, office work and relationships. So, I made a foolproof scheme to tackle this.

The scheme: When there is a 'flow', I make sure that everything is setup to run on automatic so that when I start ebbing, I don't need to pay attention. And that meant doing the dirty work up-front so that I can set sail without worries.

How the dirty work's done?

"If the whole world was equal, people earned similar wages and had similar desires throughout, it would be a drab. But there are flaws in this world and that's why knowledge is the reason to earn and prosper better. Now, tell me something about the spending habits of your generation, I don't know already."

- Kimberly (name changed), 29, *the very first conversation with my manager in the hotel industry*

I found that one of the best ways is to learn from the mistakes made by others so that we don't repeat them. And where better to start than from home.

Home: Many of our parents bought a home, paid EMI's, paid EMI's and then paid more EMI's. Some of them were not satisfied with one ride and wanted another home with another round of EMI's. Did they get to take vacations? Not much. Did they become finance greats? - Not many. Do you want to copy their finance ideas - yes? Should you - no!

Friends: They buy a 2-wheeler even before they get out of college, buy a 4-wheeler right after they get married and copy their forefathers' method of buying everything with EMI's and work for the banks most of their adult life. *Ahem*, you know where I'm going with this.

Relatives: Most think that tax saving is money-management and getting returns on an insurance policy is paramount. Travel or foreign vacations are considered as something for the rich while they expend abnormal amounts